

Hanson Li—Resume

Phone: 1 3 0 5 1 7 2 5 4 5 1

Email: XuehanLi@gmail.com

Portfolio Link: www.xuehanli.com

Core Skills

- Level guidance, Combat space design, Puzzle design, Architectural design, Architectural psychology, Structural design, Creation of architectural atmosphere, quest design, etc.
- UE5 team work; Skilled at integrating architectural theory with level design—such as spatial permeability and visual guidance; The fusion of architectural typology with gameplay mechanics; The relationship between spatial scale and "flow," ;Urban imagery and circulation design; Spatial syntax and topological analysis; Utilizing architectural simulation software to effectively analyze levels.
- Software: Unity, UE5, Perforce, Jira, 3dmax, SketchUp, Rhino, hammer, creation kit, illustrator, PS....

Individual Project

2025.10-2025.12 half-life2 Individual Level

- Master puzzle design by selecting mechanics with potential and using visual cues to guide players toward the level's ultimate objective. Establish a logical puzzle-solving progression that allows players to continuously learn, reinforce, expand upon, and be tested on these mechanics. Convey puzzle-related information through environmental design and in-game staging. Employ techniques such as "breaking path dependency" and "mixing mechanics" to foster fresh insights into the game's systems. Design moments of "retrospective revelation" that—while reusing space—transform early-game foreshadowing into the key to solving final-stage puzzles, thereby experimenting with the application of "knowledge locks."

2026.2-2026.5 Starfield Modded Level

- Design the outdoor areas by leveraging landmarks, roads, boundaries, and nodes, while using architectural typology to shape indoor gameplay and enhance vertical combat experiences. Integrate spatial storytelling with architectural scale and interior furnishings. Strategically place resources and design player flow paths. Enable diverse gameplay through the reuse of spaces while simultaneously reducing development costs.

2026.5-2026.7 Starfield Modded Level (Call of Duty Zombies-style)

- Leverage cover placement and spatial loop designs to provide players with an experience reminiscent of the *Call of Duty* Zombies mode. Utilize varied spatial layouts to manage weapon distribution and diversify the player experience. Employ data analysis to balance damage, currency, and health, ensuring overall game balance.

2026.9-2027.5 Dying light Modded level (thesis)

- This thesis employs graph theory to analyze level layouts in "Souls-like" games. By examining player cognitive load, it analyzes how these games utilize shortcuts and verticality to dynamically adjust that load and create a sense of surprise during exploration. The research establishes formulas for rapidly verifying the topological structure of such maps and provides a method to quantitatively measure the sense of surprise generated by shortcuts and verticality.

Gaming Experience

Nioh(23) 100h; Monster hunter(wilds, rise, world)1000h; Dark soul(123) 200h; Elden Ring 120h; The First Berserker: Khazan

Internship Experience

2025.5-2025.8 Systems and Combat Designer for a Hades-like in Dota 2 Arcade game

- Developed skill builds, designed meta-progression and monetization mechanics, conducted numerical balancing/testing, and optimized arena design.

Educational Background

- 2018.9–2024.7 Bachelor's Degree in Architecture, School of Architecture, Southeast University(CN)
- 2025.8-2027.5 Master's Degree in Level Design, Southern Methodist University (USA)

Campus Experience

2020.9-2021.7 President of the Woodworking Club, School of Architecture

- Woodworking Club: Instruction, scheduling, and safety maintenance

2024.6 Outstanding Graduation Projects from the School of Architecture